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On the *Izbornik* of 1073

HORACE G. LUNT

The nine-hundredth anniversary of the *Izbornik* of 1073, the second-oldest dated Slavic manuscript and the largest and most opulent of all the early codexes, was to have been marked by the publication of a new edition.¹ When the date arrived, there was a series of scholarly meetings, but the published result has been only a few essays, none of them of major import.² It is particularly disconcerting that even the leading Soviet specialists in various fields were unable to examine the manuscript itself in order to settle such elementary questions as the make-up of gatherings.³ One hopes that the authorities of the Moscow Historical Museum will relent sufficiently to allow proper technical studies to be made, and particularly to ensure that a full photographic record is made before the manuscript deteriorates further. At the very least, good microfilm copies should be made available to the scholarly world.⁴

¹ The photolithographic edition of 1880, published by the Obščestvo ljubitelej drevnej pis'mennosti (St. Petersburg) in 360 copies at the expense of the wealthy merchant T. S. Morozov, though not fully accurate, has served generations of scholars. The currently available reprint, reduced in size but fully legible (*Monumenta linguae slavicae*, vol. 3, [Wiesbaden, 1965]), has been helpful to Western scholars, but remains unmentioned by Soviet authors. Only part of O. M. Bodjanskij's scholarly edition survived; it was printed posthumously in *Čtenija v imp. Moskovskom obščestve istorii i drevnostej Rossijskix*, 1882, bk. 4. An introductory note by A. Djuvernua contains important observations that deserve further investigation. [See fn. 52, below.]

² The most important, by Soviet and Bulgarian scholars, appeared in *Izbornik 1073 g.: Sbornik statej*, ed. B. A. Rybakov, (Moscow, 1977). I cite the manuscript as I73, this volume as IS.

³ See IS 20. Thus R. A. Simonov, writing about the possible shape of a symbol representing "900," was able without trouble to obtain a microfilm of the well-known early tenth-century Paris manuscript *Coislin*. 120 and reproduce the pertinent page (IS 171) so the reader sees at once the special *sampi*. In sharp contrast, the Soviet scholar was forced to speculate for several pages about the shape of the symbol in I73, because he could neither look at the single page in the museum in Moscow nor obtain a photograph.

⁴ It is a sad commentary on the state of Slavic studies in the twentieth century that the best description is still A. Gorskij and K. Nevostruev, *Opisanie slavjanskix rukopisej Moskovskoj Sinodal'noj biblioteki*, vol. 2, pt. 2 (Moscow, 1859), pp. 365-405 (reprinted as vol. 2 of *Monumenta linguae slavicae*, [Wiesbaden,] 1964). The authors make occasional

Not only do the recent publications fail, on the whole, to record progress in the study of I73,⁵ but they tend to repeat long outmoded views and to magnify old misunderstandings. I should like, therefore, to look briefly at the contents of the work, to make some observations concerning the codicological history of the manuscript, and to call attention once again to the relationship of the Slavonic florilegium to its Greek prototype.

As is well known, the four-line colophon of *Ioann dijak* states that the *Izbornik* was written for Grand Prince Svjatoslav in 1073.⁶ This dedication is affirmed by a laudatory poem which is found at the beginning of the codex⁷ and again immediately after the colophon. A Russian manuscript of about 1500 with almost exactly the same content has the same poem at the beginning, but with the name Simeon instead of Svjatoslav.⁸ In conjunction with the obvious South Slavic origin

reference to an earlier account based on the careful copy of I73 made by the artist Ratšin in 1817 for Count Rumjancev, namely, Aleksandr Vostokov, *Opisanie russkix i slovenskix rukopisej Rumjancevskogo muzeuma* (St. Petersburg), 1842, pp. 499-506. Excellent though these works are on their own terms, they are hardly up to date.

⁵ For example, L. P. Žukovskaja touches on the immensely interesting vocabulary of I73 only by rearranging the lexical material she culled from Nevostruev's description ("Leksika Izbornika 1073 g. v 'Opisanii rukopisej Sinodal'noj biblioteki,'" IS 152-169), with skimpy random notes on I. I. Sreznevskij's treatment in his *Materialy dlja slovarja drevnerusskogo jazyka* (St. Petersburg, 1893-1912; reprinted, Graz, 1955-56 [still available] and Moscow, 1968 [out of print]). I comment briefly on certain points in fn. 51, below.

⁶ The last three lines of the colophon were written with a different pen and, according to Gorskij and Nevostruev (*Opisanie*, 2, pt. 2: 367), at least part is on scraped parchment; IS 218 has a fairly clear reproduction (mislabelled [as 2 verso], this is fol. 263c). These lines should be examined and photographed with up-to-date ultra-violet, infra-red and other techniques to see if any of the erased words can be discerned. [See post-script, p. 376.] I assume that Ioann is the scribe who wrote folios 86a15-264a24; another scribe, perhaps a supervisor, began and ended the manuscript.

⁷ It starts on folio 2 verso, where the text is crowded into an elaborately illuminated ornamental frame, but spills over to folio 2 recto, which is occupied by a portrait of Christ. Surely the portrait represents the original verso; this folio was incorrectly placed when the volume was bound. It would be normal for the poem to start on the recto, and for Christ to be placed facing the full-page picture of the church and church fathers. In the 1965 reprint, oddly enough, a mirror image of 2^r was printed.

⁸ This Kiril-Belozero manuscript (Kir.Bel. 5/1082) was first reported to be dated 1445. Djuvernua, however (cf. fn. 1, above), mentions no date. L. Masing argued persuasively (*Archiv f. slav. Phil.* 8 [1885]: 373-4) that the letters allegedly standing for "953" and taken to mean "6953" = 1445 were in fact "ami" or "amn" and clearly meant "amen"; he found the script very similar to a manuscript dated 1507. One wonders why the explicit date is given in the unsigned introduction to IS (p. 3) and by several authors, e.g., IS 25, 52, 222; only B. St. Angelov is more circumspect, IS 250. Masing's brief discussion (pp. 388-389) shows that KB and I73 derive from a common ancestor, while Djuvernua's notes (cf. fn. 1, above) make it clear that KB occasionally preserves older readings. Kuev for unstated reasons declares it to be an "almost exact copy" of I73.

of the text and translation, this fact has traditionally been accepted as proof that the original was dedicated to Simeon of Bulgaria (d. 927).

What is the subject matter of this volume? How is it presented? Russian and Bulgarian scholars seem to be impelled to insist on the high intellectual level of the *Izbornik*, and particularly its “encyclopedic character.” The unsigned introduction to IS speaks of “articles on astronomy and the philosophy of nature, mathematics and physics, zoology and botany, grammar and poetics, history, ethics and Christian theology” (p. 3). It is true that these topics are all mentioned, but this description—and others like it in several of the articles in IS—raise expectations in a modern reader that certainly will not be met by the text itself. Gorskij and Nevostruev were quite right to class this codex among “dogmatic and spiritual-moral” works; this is primarily a collection of articles and excerpts from scripture and the church fathers, supplemented by lists of general data to help explain some of the difficult questions which might occur to the reader as he goes through the texts.

The items of less specific religious nature have been enumerated briefly by Ihor Ševčenko,⁹ but it should be emphasized that most of the pieces dignified by the title of treatise are in fact merely lists. Six of them together occupy just over four columns, 250c7-251c15: a list of “planets” and signs of the zodiac, a list of Roman months with notes on diet or habits,¹⁰ and the names of Jewish, Macedonian, Greek, and Egyptian months. The four items on the preceding pages, 247c18-250c, give a more detailed chronology of the life of Jesus and how dates are calculated, but they hardly constitute encyclopedic information on astronomy. These sixteen columns of *varia chronologica*, together with the final eight and one-half columns, 264a-266b, that contain the list of Roman emperors, take up less than two percent of the manuscript.

The *Izbornik* as a whole is made up of six thematic groups of works or excerpts of extremely different size and composition.¹¹ The chronological items comprise section V (plus the final addendum). Section I

⁹ “Remarks on the Diffusion of Byzantine Scientific and Pseudo-Scientific Literature among the Orthodox Slavs,” *Slavonic and East European Review* 59 (1981): 332-333.

¹⁰ E.g., “7. September 30 [days], don’t eat milk; 8. October 31, don’t eat acid [foods] (*ocbtena*). 9. October [*sic*!] 30, don’t wash yourself often; 10. December 31, don’t eat cabbage.” The rule for July is “Refrain from *afrodisii*.” The untranslated ἀφροδίσια ‘sexual pleasures’ is glossed by the scribe or a contemporary as *otb mnogiyix brašen* ‘much food’. Is this prudery or ignorance?

¹¹ The scribe of 173 has confused major and minor items in providing numerical labels for sections of text. It is the sense and provenance of the works that determine the subdivisions I am discussing here.

includes the opening eight articles on the nature of the Holy Trinity and of true faith, plus the ninth, which gives an account of the six Ecumenical Councils and their decisions (fol. 4-27b, about nine percent of the whole codex).

Section II, folios 27b-223b, over seventy-five percent of the codex, is itself a florilegium, the *Questions and Answers* attributed to Anastasius of Sinai. This compilation, known in several recensions, consists of numerous and heterogeneous component parts that are organized according to a clear plan.¹² A question is posed, and Anastasius provides his answer, followed by appropriate quotations from scripture or the church fathers that affirm and elaborate on the points he has made or else explain some of the allusions. In the portion we will discuss in some detail below, for instance, Question 20 is, in shortened paraphrase, "What power enables false believers often to prophesy and work miracles?" Anastasius's own long answer is backed up by passages from Jeremiah, Ezekiel, Ecclesiastes, Wisdom, Romans, the Constitutions of the Apostles, Theodoret, Cyril of Alexandria, and Chrysostom. Question 21 ("Why don't men know the day of their own death...?") has but four supporting authors—Gregory of Nazianzus, Chrysostom, Diadochus, and Nilus.¹³

Much of the text is straightforward and clear. Many passages, however, contain elaborate metaphorical explanations, involving parables, allusive comparisons, analogies and antitheses, complex allegory, and

¹² Marcel Richard, who has surveyed the whole material, classes this work as a *monastic* florilegium (not "sacro-profane"); he has outlined its history. The 154-question version of this work (with seven unnumbered questions), which was compiled in the eleventh century, is available in volume 89 of Migne's *Patrologia graeca*, and thus serves as the usual basis for reference. I73 reflects a widely-known, 88-question edition of about 900, itself based on somewhat older sources. The text is well preserved in two early copies, *Vaticanus graecus* 423 and *Coislin*. 120 (Paris), to which we will return. Anastasius of Sinai lived in the eighth century, and a number of the questions must be labeled "pseudo-Anastasius." See Richard, *Florilèges spirituels grecs*, in *Dictionnaire de Spiritualité*, vol. 5 (1964), cols. 475-512, esp. 500-501; also, "Les véritables 'Questions et réponses d'Anastase le Sinaïte,'" *Institut de Recherche et d'Histoire des Textes, Bulletin No. 5* (1967-68), pp. 39-56. Richard does not deal with the florilegia like ours in which the *Questions* are imbedded. This perhaps is a problem which Slavists should investigate in connection with the history of I73.

¹³ The quotations vary considerably in length. Taking Vat.gr. 423 as the standard, 20A (i.e., the question plus answer) occupies 357 lines; 20B (Jeremiah 23:16, 21) 7 lines; 20C (Ezekiel 14:7-10, 13:17) 23; 20D (Ecc 8:7-8, 11:5) 14; 20E (Wisdom 9:13-17) 10; 20F (Rom 11:33-4) 6; 20G 26; 20H 40; 20I 78; 20J 18. 21A has 90 lines; 21B 23; 21C 26; 21D 32; 21E 33. Parenthetically, let me note that scribes were particularly likely to become confused when copying the short bits, and it is understandable that such items can be omitted or else put in at a later point in the expected sequence.

hair-splitting definitions based on concepts drawn from various philosophical traditions and couched in phrases built, with varying degrees of skill, on classical rhetorical theory and practice. Some are abstruse but understandable; others range from nebulous to impenetrable. It makes sense, then, that the next block of four articles (divided into twenty items by the scribe, 223c-241c) should consist of works dealing with such terms as nature and essence, the difference between real and spiritual, and enumerating rhetorical devices.¹⁴ While a reader may find some profit in this section III, this seven percent of I73 hardly constitutes encyclopedic treatment of rhetoric or philosophy, let alone grammar.

Section IV again discusses the nature of God, especially the Holy Trinity, in four more excerpts which take up somewhat more space than the chronological pieces, 241c-247c. Finally, the Ten Commandments are given, followed by three lists of the canon of books of the Old and New Testaments (with apocrypha and pseudepigrapha), a list of the prophets, a brief outline of the lives of the prophets, and finally a list of the twelve and the seventy apostles of Christ.

There is, to be sure, a great deal of curious information scattered among the answers. Question 40, "What was the ephod, through which the high priest asked questions of God?," requires an answer mentioning emeralds; a supplementary excerpt from Chrysostom refers also to "twelve stones," and this in turn is elucidated in a piece by Epiphanius defining twelve (semi-)precious stones, where they come from (including fantastic details), and their medical properties. (Incidentally, this section is a treasure-house of words denoting color, cf. fn. 51, below.) But such nuggets cannot change the fact that I73 reflects a religious compilation based on an average monastic library,¹⁵ not a comprehensive source of general information.

¹⁴ The section by Choeroboscus on tropes and figures has been given a great deal of attention in recent scholarship, including two articles in IS, and from the time of Buslaev it has been almost required in chrestomathies of Russian language and literature. (Thus it is the sole representative of I73 in O. I. Bilec'kyj's *Xrestomatija davn'oji ukrains'koji literatury*, published in 1967.) Yet is a faulty copy of a mediocre translation of a poorly abridged technical work that at best is very difficult to follow and at worst simply incomprehensible: all this was spelled out in detail by Ihor Ševčenko in his review of Justinia Besharov, *Imagery of the Igor' Tale in the Light of Byzantino-Slavic Poetic Theory* (Leiden, 1956), in *Speculum* 32 (1957): 538-543.

¹⁵ This is Richard's judgment of the Anastasius florilegium, but it applies as well to the whole volume. Indeed, the entire body of early Slavonic translations represents at best a narrow selection—with a strong monastic bias—from the vast treasures presumably available in Byzantium; see the stern assessment by Francis J. Thomson, "The Nature of the Reception of Christian Byzantine Culture in Russia in the Tenth to Thirteenth

The size of I73 and its rich ornamentation, together with its association with the glorious Simeon, understandably led nineteenth-century philologists to assume that I73 must have been copied directly and faithfully from the Preslav original, which — they believed — must also have been a magnificent codex. However, it is little short of astonishing that contemporary scholars can repeat — and embroider on — this romantic notion.¹⁶

A casual observer leafing through the volume will notice rich illumination on the first four folios, then absolutely nothing to catch one's eye until folio 128, both sides of which are full-page illustrations, while 129r has an elaborate head-piece. Much further on, the margins of 250v and 251r are occupied by illustrations of the signs of the zodiac which obviously were added after the text had been written in the normal space. Finally, the last words of a prayer preceding the colophon (*vb minuštija věky věkomъ aminъ* 263c) are written in a narrowing space, allowing room for a bird on each side of the column. An obvious question arises: why the special pages in the middle of the codex?¹⁷

A satisfactory explanation was proposed by Robert H. Whitman in his 1963 Harvard dissertation, and his major conclusions have long been available to the scholarly world.¹⁸ However, it seems necessary once again to present and reinforce the salient points. We must look more closely at the text and its subdivisions.

The text is broken into a large number of individual articles which are provided with headings; an article may occupy several pages or only a

Centuries and its Implications for Russian Culture," *Slavica Gandensia* 5 (1978): 107-139.

As to the content, the space devoted to the Holy Trinity is entirely in keeping with the concerns of the time of Photius and his successors. The role of the *Filioque* in the expulsion of the disciples of Methodius from Moravia is reported in detail in the Greek *Life* of Clement of Ohrid by Theophylactus; we can speculate, therefore, that it was Clement or Naum or another of the Moravian missionaries who selected this particular florilegium for translation into Old Church Slavonic, in order to prepare Slavic Christians to deal with advocates of the *Filioque* or related unorthodox doctrines.

¹⁶ M. V. Ščepkina, IS 232ff., P. N. Dinekov, IS 279.

¹⁷ The verse encomium occupies 263d and most of 264a, still in the hand of the scribe who wrote the bulk of the text (from 86a15), as though a continuation of the colophon (cf. fn. 6, above). Then follows a chronological outline very like Nicephorus's *Chronographia brevis* (to 266b9) in the hand of the first scribe. Since a very similar text occurs in a comparable position in a Greek parallel manuscript, Coislin. 120, one may conjecture that it was inadvertently left out by the impatient Ioann (if he was indeed the major scribe) and had to be added by the supervisor of the whole work.

¹⁸ "The Morphology of the *Svjatoslav Izbornik* of 1073" (unpublished); "The 1073 *Izbornik*: The Manuscript and its Sources," *Indiana Slavic Studies* 4 (1967): 252-267; "Une interpolation tardive de l'*Izbornik* de 1073," *Revue des études slaves* 46 (1967): 27-33.

couple of lines. Superficially it would seem that this is simply an assemblage of texts of differing length, but an attentive reader quickly sees that some items are clearly subordinate to others. Apparently the copyists who were required to reproduce the collection were chiefly concerned with keeping track of the items in order to make sure that all were accounted for. Therefore each section, major or minor, was assigned a number.

Folios 123-128r contain a list of 189 titles or introductory words which turn out to correspond almost exactly to the marginal numeration of the sections of text from 129a to the last item before the colophon.¹⁹ The final twenty-one lines of the column preceding this index, 122d, was left blank after the end of a section completed at line 8.²⁰ The verso of folio 127 was also left blank, but a patristic passage was written in later (15th century?). Thus one text and numbered series of items ends at 122d; a table of contents for a new series follows immediately, then come a blank page, two full-page illustrations, and an illuminated half-page with the first text of a second numbered series. It certainly looks as though 123 marks the beginning of a new volume. Yet folios 124-130 constitute signature number 17 of I73, if the extant numbers at the foot of 124a and 130d are to be trusted.²¹

The answer, as Whitman concluded, is that I73 was copied from a model which consisted of two separate volumes.

Could the two-volume izbornik²² have been the original work made for Simeon? Surely not: the boundary was put at an inappropriate place in the text, and the mechanical division was badly botched. The second

¹⁹ Discrepancies in the list and text are displayed in a tabular comparison of the number and order of selections of I73 and later Russian copies published in 1886 by Leonard Masing, *Archiv für slavische Philologie* 9 (1886): 77-112. The tables show that items in the first part of I73 are numbered from 1 to 206, then by error 77 to 104, giving a total of 234 individual sections; the second part has 194.

²⁰ The space was subsequently partly filled by a rather crude design with two birds and a few words. It should be noted that the leaves here are out of order, probably because of an error in binding. The sequence is 117, 149-152, 122-130; then a quaternion is missing. Folio 123 was thus close to the mid-point of the whole codex.

²¹ See L. P. Žukovskaja, IS 19-20. She suggests that a folio is missing after 128, and 126 is the half-sheet. It would seem more likely that 126-27, with the end of the index, are a single sheet, while 128, entirely done by the illustrator(s), is the odd folio. Žukovskaja does not make it clear that signature 16 was a full quaternion made up of folios now numbered 116-17, 149-52, 122-23; she fails to mention that the number 16 at the foot of 116a was omitted in the photolithograph, but noted in the long list of errata published by A. A. Šaxmatov, *Archiv für slavische Philologie* 6 (1882): 590-597.

²² The terms *miscellany* and *syllogē* have been used for this work; I prefer to keep the Slavonic title.

volume begins with a text that is clearly a subdivision of a larger unit, as we see below, but that same text is already included toward the end of the first volume, along with some material which is extraneous to the unit in question.

Moreover, the codex which was the basis for the division was itself already faulty because of a mechanical error, as Whitman pointed out. The scribe of this earlier codex had transposed two blocks of text, thereby disturbing the sequence of material by splitting and joining three individual passages in a way that made little or no sense. However, the slightly odd sentences that resulted in three separate places did not cause later scribes to realize that anything was amiss.²³ Here it is possible only to sketch the complexities of the perturbations underlying the midpoint of I73, for the problems cannot be fully delineated — much less solved — without the material from several manuscripts I do not have access to.²⁴

The original sequence is surely that preserved in the two early tenth-century Greek manuscripts, *Vaticanus graecus* 423 and *Paris Coislin*. 120, which correspond closely to I73 and its later congeners.²⁵

The display in Table 1 (p. 368)²⁶ concerns Question 20 with its nine supplementary texts, 21 with four, 22 with six, and 23 with four. The two Greek manuscripts are compared to I73 and to a fifteenth-century Russian manuscript, *Rumjancev* 6, at the Lenin Library. R6 does not

²³ Masing was concerned with comparing items numbered by the scribes of I73, KB, etc.; his footnotes concerning the disturbance here are cryptic. The disturbance is not indicated in the tables by L. P. Grjazina and N. A. Ščerbačeva that display the sequence of textual items in I73 and five manuscripts of the Lenin Library, IS 74.

²⁴ Beside the 1880 photolithograph and its 1965 reprint, I have only a microfilm of *Rumjancev* 6, Masing's R1.

²⁵ Descriptions were published by Robert Devreesse, *Codices Vaticani Graeci*, vol. 2 (= *Codices* 330-363, The Vatican, 1937), pp. 138-141, and *Catalogue des Manuscrits Grecs*, vol. 2: *Le Fond Coislin* (Paris: Bibliothèque Nationale, Département des Manuscrits, 1945), pp. 109-111. I will discuss the relationship of V423 to C120 in more detail below; my references to them are based on photo-copies graciously made available to me by Ihor Ševčenko. I should like to thank Jeffrey Featherstone and Sophia Georgiopolou for their generous help in reading the manuscripts and for answers to many related questions about Byzantine literature and language. I am particularly indebted to Mr. Featherstone for transcribing several passages from the photos.

²⁶ The table displays the relationship of the Greek model (and, by inference, its presumably equivalent OCS version) to the hypothetical Russian model that has the typical perturbation exhibited in R6, and the further deviation of I73 from the Russian prototype.

This method of display was worked out by Hugh M. Olmsted for dealing with the extraordinarily complex *sborniki* of the sixteenth-seventeenth centuries; see his "Studies in the early manuscript tradition of Maksim Grek's collected works" (Ph.D. dissertation, Harvard University, 1978).

contain all the texts of I73, but in these passages it can serve as the model which shows the reversal of blocks of text in precisely the spots we must assume for I73.

In this discussion, two reasons for subdividing a given textual unit must be distinguished. For a subdivision arising because of a loss of folios in a manuscript, I use the symbols *a* and *b*. For a division caused by a mechanical error, I use *x* and *y*. Thus 20Ax is the first portion of the answer to Question 20 up to the point where an earlier scribe erroneously skipped to 20Gy, i.e., the second fragment of the sixth text adduced as a supplement to the original answer.

The scribes of the two Greek manuscripts obviously understood the structure of Anastasius's work, and the questions are usually numbered correctly, that is, the main subdivisions are recognized and labelled.²⁷ In contrast, the Slavic scribes seem to have been little concerned with the real sense of the material; we have to assume that they were inattentive, for otherwise their errors and inconsistencies are impossible to account for. The numbering in I73 (and analogous numbers in several later texts) demonstrates that the model at hand was concerned only with providing each selection, or item, with a separate label. There are places where a major subdivision is unnumbered, e.g., Question 60, at 181a3.²⁸ In the part we are examining here, the heading plus the incomplete first sentence of 20I constituted a section which, in the opinion of the scribe of I73, merited the number 100.²⁹ Since the sense did not matter much, it was possible for a scribe to transpose texts in such a way as to divide items 20A, 20G and 21A and reunite them into the sections labelled 98, 4, and 10 in I73. In Table 1 the hybrid subdivisions are 20Ax/20Gy, 21Ax/20Ay, and 20Gx/21Ay. Analysis of I73 is complicated here by the loss of signature number 18, which originally followed folio 130, but the index allows us at least to establish the name and order of the items.

²⁷ In terms of the 154-question sequence, V423 and C120 reflect a four-part arrangement with separately numbered questions: 1-22; 23-53; 54-59, 142-143; 144-151, 60-70, 128, 71-74, 152-154. The actual labels in the manuscripts are confused or omitted in the second "chapter" but agree in the other three. The division neatly fits Richard's observation that the first group deals with moral problems, the other three with the Bible—specifically questions about the Old Testament, the Epistles, and the New Testament.

²⁸ On the other hand, where PG 89 573 has two questions, 33 and 34, I73 145d25-26 agrees with C and V in having a single continuous text.

²⁹ The same sort of muddle occurs on 213v, where the scribe became confused and put in a portion of a previous item (213d5-19 = 213b23-c8, with interesting variations of detail), then repeated a second item (213c9-d23 = 213d20-214a15: heading changed from *Theologovo* to *Bogoslovca!*), with a number for each heading.

				19C	97	
				20Ax	98	
				20Gy		
				20H	99	
				20Ix	100	
				Gregory I	101	Gregory sermon
				2	102	
				3	103	
				4	104	
				Index		Index
				Illuminated pages		
				20H	1	
				20I	2	
				20J	3	
				21Axa	4	
				*21Axb		
				*20Ay		
				*20B	(5)	
				* C	(6)	
				* D	(7)	
				* E	(8)	
				* F	(9)	
				*20Gx	(10)	
				*21Ay		
				*21B	(11)	
				* C	(12)	
				* D	(13)	
				* E	(14)	
				*22A	(15)	
				* B	(16)	
				* C	(17)	
				* D	(18)	
				* E	(19)	
				* F	(20)	
				* G	(21)	
				*23A	(22)	
				* B	(23)	
				*23D	(24)	
				*23C1	(25)	
				?		
				*24Aa	(26)	
				24Ab		
				24B	27	
				25A	28	

Table 1

Thus, hybrid item 4 is represented only by two lines of the heading, symbolized here as 21 Axa; by inference we posit continuation of the text in a form symbolized as 20Axb plus 20Ay.³⁰ Transposition of items 23C and D is typical of what can happen with short subdivisions. C1 is the names of forty great rivers, C2 the names of twelve great mountains. The index of I73 mentions the rivers only; there is no way to guess whether the label is abbreviated, or whether the short list of mountains was indeed omitted.

Masing's tables show that all Slavic manuscripts known to him have two serious lacunae. First, the text jumps in mid-sentence from a subdivision of Question 48 to one of 52, so that all of Questions 49-51 are lost. In R6 the scribe places no marking at all between the dangling relative pronoun *o nem'ze* and the vocative *gospodi* of a totally unrelated sentence. I73 recognizes the anomaly at least by marking the spot, 163c24, with the four-dot lozenge usually used to indicate the end of a heading or full subsection. Second, I73 215d26 is close to the end of Question 152B, but 27 is well down in Question 153; the equivalent of V423 371v24-372r7 or C120 187v28-188r25 has been lost. Here neither I73 nor R6 has any punctuation to mark the break. It seems highly improbable that such meaningless juxtapositions could have occurred in the original translation or even a careful copy made for the original patron. These gross errors surely constitute proof that there were intermediary copies between Simeon's time and Svjatoslav's.³¹

A manuscript of more than about 275 parchment folios is somewhat unwieldy, and is easier to handle if divided into two volumes, even though that might not be the original intention of the scribe. Thus Vat. gr. 423, whose pages measure 235 × 165 mm., is at present bound in two covers, having been divided at a spot where a section ended on the last page of a gathering. The first page of the second volume is labelled 27 in a Greek hand younger than the manuscript itself to identify the signature, and with the modern numeral 227 to indicate the folio. The text starts with the heading of 23C1, that is, within Question 23. It seems

³⁰ A sequence like 23Ax 23Ay is used in the V423 column to show where the potential break would be in the correct original text. In the I73 column, asterisks mark items assumed to have been present on the pages of the now missing eighteenth signature.

³¹ One assumes from Masing's presentation that KB shares the transposition in Questions 20 and 21, and is divided into two sequences of items like I73. The first part ends with the hybrid 20Ax/20Gy, but omits the incorrectly placed 20H and fragmentary 20Ix, as well as the third of the four Gregory excerpts. Still another minor omission would not show up in Masing's tables, for the item number is untouched: in Question 26 the question itself is truncated and a line or two of the answer is lost, I73 135b = R6 140r.

very likely that a Slavic predecessor of I73 was also a quarto volume which was arbitrarily divided. Secondly, a scribe added the four short excerpts from the sermon by Gregory of Nazianzus on baptism at the end of the first volume.³² At about this time, indices were prepared for the two volumes; sometime afterwards, we may presume, the whole work was again copied into a single codex. This then would explain the very close similarity of the Belozero volume (containing the poem to Simeon) and I73. A major difference, however, would be an intermediary copy with two folio volumes, and illustrations at the beginning of each.

Why should this florilegium be produced with such lavish care? No elaborately illustrated codex in the Byzantine tradition has this sort of text. I submit that we have here an arbitrary choice dependent on local Russian criteria.

The ornamentation, as V.D. Lixačeva demonstrated, IS 204-216, derives from nearly contemporary Byzantine models. While the picture of the princely family may ultimately have been inspired by an older Bulgarian family portrait, this need not have been so. Indeed, we might speculate that there was an older portrait of Jaroslav, surely the most influential patron of Slavic letters in Rus'; we might even conjecture that the *izbornik* itself could have been dedicated to Jaroslav in its earliest luxurious Russian edition.³³

Was the OCS translation dedicated to Simeon? The poem was surely added before 1073, but was it originally written for this *izbornik*? The text celebrates the erudition of Simeon and praises his sponsorship of the translation of edificatory works, specifically St. Basil. The first selection in I73 is indeed by this prolific writer; but it is a very specific piece about the definition of a true Christian, and not the kind of general work the poem seems to allude to. Zoe Hauptová argues convincingly that the encomium was intended rather as an introduction to the Hexameron of Ioan Exarch.³⁴ Though surely a product of Simeon's time and milieu, the *izbornik* was not necessarily dedicated expressly to him.

³² The four excerpts, published by Whitman in RES1 (see fn. 18 above), were surely taken from a Russian copy of the sermon very like the one that survives in the well-known eleventh-century volume of thirteen sermons, as Whitman convincingly demonstrates.

³³ The number of syllables in the names Simeon, Jaroslav, Izjaslav, and Svjatoslav are the same, so the substitution of one for another makes no difference in the syllabic meter of the poem. [See postscript, p. 376.] It should be emphasized that the inclusion of the poem on folio 2v certainly looks like a last-minute change of plan. The carefully illuminated frame is far too small to have been originally intended for this text.

³⁴ Zoe Xauptova, "Poxvala carju Simeonu, ee avtor i vizantijskie obrazy," *Starobolgarska literatura*, bk. 10, 1981, pp. 88-94.

Let me then state tentative theses to be tested by further research. First, we may assume that this modest florilegium was introduced to Bulgarian readers in the form of a quarto volume, with no special ornamentation. A copy, possibly already with a significant lacuna in the Questions of Anastasius, found its way to Rus' with other volumes of the extensive literature that had been translated in Byzantium and Moravia, and perhaps Pannonia, Rome, and Croatia in the ninth century, as well as in the eastern and western parts of the Bulgarian Empire, and perhaps also the Holy Land, during the tenth and early eleventh centuries. Second, in an early copy made from this South Slavic codex, portions of Questions 20 and 21 were transposed. Third, this faulty copy became the model for a version which was divided into two volumes, each provided with an index; at this point the encomium to Simeon was added at the end of the second volume.³⁵ Fourth, an elegant edition with illustrations at the beginning of each volume was made, very likely dedicated to a Rus' prince, let us suppose Jaroslav. And finally this two-volume work was reproduced in a single tome, with up-dated art-work and an appropriately modified dedication to the current patron, Svjatoslav.

What about the text or texts from which the translation was made?

Vostokov knew the Paris Greek manuscript *Coislin*. 120 only from Monfaucon's 1715 description, but he recognized that it was essentially the same florilegium as I73. At the same time, he saw differences that proved C120 could not have been the actual original from which the Slavic translators worked in Simeon's Bulgaria. Bodjanskij commissioned an exact copy of C120, and he based his edition of I73 on it; this copy has apparently been available to other scholars in Moscow from time to time. *Codex Vaticanus graecus* 423 has often been mentioned in connection with I73,³⁶ but it has not yet been exploited for scholarly purposes. A recent enthusiastic note holds that I73 follows V423 "section after section and page after page," but the author stops short of the claim that this was indeed the original.³⁷ A more sober look reveals,

³⁵ I assume that the index to the first part was either lost in the last-minute rearrangement when the dedication to Svjatoslav was put in at the beginning of I73 or — more likely — in later centuries.

³⁶ See especially Ihor Ševčenko, in *Speculum* 32 (1957): 78.

³⁷ Božidar Pejčev, "Cod. Vat. gr. 423 - ein Analogus dem Izbornik J. 1073," *Palaeobulgarica* 1 (1977): 78. Pejčev's breathless air of discovery is hard to understand in view of the fact that the correspondence between V423 and C120 was mentioned by Robert Devreesse both in his 1937 description of Vatican manuscripts and his 1945 description of the Coislin collection, as was duly noted by Whitman (1967, fns. 13 and 14). For more recent scholarly notices, see Ihor Ševčenko, *Slavonic and East European Review* 59 (1981): 332, fn. 27.

as might be expected, that V423, too, has its defects. There is no need to claim that either of these early tenth-century manuscripts was known to Simeon's bookmen; what is important is that the discrepancies between them are trivial and the coincidence of both—or, more rarely, only one—of them with I73 is close to one hundred percent.³⁸ We can confidently posit that C120, V423, and a third contemporary copy which found its way to Bulgaria all stem directly from a single model.³⁹ On the whole, the portions that concern Slavists are best preserved in 423, but it does have omissions and minor deviations where 120 and I73 agree on details we must ascribe to the prototype. Unfortunately, 423 becomes illegible at the end (I73 258c14; the final page, 423v, presumably had the text of I73 258c14-d19).⁴⁰

V423 was carefully written by a fairly literate and attentive scribe; there are few erasures and almost no corrections. C120, on the other hand, is full of mistakes, omissions, erasures, and marginal notations.⁴¹ Many errors were corrected by the scribe, still others by later hands.

³⁸ The only substantial difference is that C has a much fuller version of one article than V and I73. The first item following Anastasius in what I have called section III is a piece on nature and essence and categories, attributed to Theodore of Raithou (I 223c-235a, subdivided into sections labelled 150-172); in C it contains additional sections that are equivalent to ten or eleven folios of I73. It is probable that V and I result from abridgement of this longer version.

³⁹ Emil Georgiev blandly states that the Greek florilegium was compiled by Bulgars under the direct supervision of Simeon, IS 263-272. It is an implausible assumption.

⁴⁰ Pejčev states that folio 228v (a misprint taken over from Devreesse for 227v) "contains remarks on the activity of Patriarch Nikolaos Mystikos between 911-925" and therefore could not be a model for I73. But the entire entry, the last in a list of patriarchs, is "90. Νικόλαος πάλιν" (both words abbreviated); the dates were supplied by Devreesse to identify which Nicolas is meant. The entry thus tells us only that C120 was written no earlier than 911. Now, the final entry in I73 has as the most recent rulers in Constantinople Constantine and Zoe, long ago identified as Constantine VII Porphyrogenitus and his mother, who died in 920; at least in terms of date, C120 could have been known when the translation was made. Pejčev states that the omission of Patriarch Nicolas from V423 means it is older than C120. But the list in question is positioned in C120 well after the point where V423 breaks off; we simply cannot know what V423 had after the end of the article on the lives of the prophets.

As for C120, it continues after the list of the first followers of Christ with lists of patriarchs, then has a gap and returns to articles about philosophical categories, breaking off again in mid-sentence. In terms of percentage, therefore, C is more heavily weighed in favor of philosophical definitions than V and I. But it is still far from being encyclopedic.

⁴¹ For example, see the photo in IS 171. The original scribe noted that "crucifixion" is pertinent to the word "birth" in the text equivalent to I 250a14; compare Migne PG 92 1057B, where the same addition is made. Lower down a much later scribe has added first πλήρη (I73 *isplēnē*) and still lower καὶ ἐξῆς ὑπέπεσε τῇ ἁμαρτίᾳ 'and next he [man] fell into sin'. I73 250b2-4 is either based on a different phrase or was incorrectly translated: *vidē i poplōzša sę grēxōmō* '[God] saw him who had lapsed because of sin'.

The minor differences between C120 and V423 shown in Table 1 are typical of the relationships throughout the two manuscripts; V423 is generally more reliable, and the common ancestor of the Slavic manuscripts went more often with 423 than with 120. Here we see a transposition of two subsections of text, 20C and D (whereby the Slavic and V423 affirm the order illustrated by still other versions of the Questions). The list of rivers and mountains, 23C1-2, is a part of the text in V423 and R6 (and probably KB); in C120 it is written in the right and bottom margin accompanying the text of 23B. In terms of content, it is obviously intended as a supplement to that item.⁴²

To establish the Greek model of the OCS translation, we need both V423 and C120. For example, Izb 120b28 *i opečaliti* has no equivalent in V258v22, but καὶ καταλυπεῖν C131v1. V omits “the holy city of Jerusalem new” which is in C and Izb 214b2-4. The beginning of the answer to Question 154 is correct in C (ἡ τοῦ θεοῦ ἐκκλησία τυπός ἐστιν...), garbled in V (Τύπος ἐστιν..., without subject) and also, in a different way, in I73 (217d27, *Božbja bo c[č]rky jestъ razumnaago mira* — the word *obrazъ* is omitted).⁴³ I73 15b24 reflects the defective scribal text of C 18v20 as printed by Bodjanskij 35.26, but V 30r21-23 has the correct full sentence — which was added by a later corrector in C. At times neither corresponds exactly to I73, e.g., 212a: *jestъ bo sudii pravdъnъ i jestъ sudi nepravdъnъ*, but V ἐστιν γὰρ κριτὴς δικαῖος καὶ ἄδικος, C ... καὶ ἐστιν ἄδικος.

It seems safe to assume that all copies of the Greek florilegium had certain items in the margins; later copyists could decide to include them in the text. A marginal addition to a subsection of Question 1 of Anastasius in both C and V (f. 34v and 62, respectively) becomes a separate section in I73 (32b6-14), numbered 30. In both Greek manuscripts it is in the margin corresponding to the last few lines of I73 31b, in the section labelled 28.⁴⁴ C120 shows a more conservative stage of development here, as in the case of item 23C. In a number of instances, a scholion which is marginal in C has been incorporated

⁴² This is an answer to the question as to whether paradise is real or imaginary. Since paradise is equated to the Garden of Eden, and Genesis names known and real rivers flowing from there, then, the argument goes, paradise must indeed be real and perceptible. Someone obviously felt it necessary to supply information about the chief rivers of the world; for good measure the great mountains were added. The lists are not in the longer version, PG 89 540-541.

⁴³ Still another variant is in PG 89 813C, Ἡ καθολικὴ ἐκκλησία τυπός ἐστι....

⁴⁴ The Migne recension of Anastasius lacks this text and many others that are marginal in C or V or both.

into the normal text in V, retaining the label scholion; I73 always omits the label.

Question 29 is accompanied by a marginal scholion at C122r (approximately I73 141a22), which has become part of the text in I73 140c25-d14; but in V it appears after the next section (roughly I 141a22), labelled scholion. Question 28, "Why did God order Abraham to be circumcised?," is followed in V by a paragraph clearly labelled scholion, 234v15-24, which is absent in C,⁴⁵ but joined directly to the question without label in I73 136d27. In the question, C spells the name Keturah correctly, Χεττούρας (gn. sg.), I73 *xetury*. V both here and in the scholion unexpectedly has Γεττούρας, while I73 maintains *xetburity*. In the following section, C and V list the sons of Shem in the margin (120v, 236r), and then C has the sons of Japheth in the margin, while V makes the list part of the text, 236v13-24, though the heading is in the top margin. I73 has both in the text, 137d28-a8 and 138d15-139a9.⁴⁶

A number of aspects of the language of I73 have been examined: it is safe to say that almost every problem should be looked at again by scholars who consistently refer to the Greek text. One hopes that the edition of the Greek now being prepared by Mario Capaldo will appear soon.⁴⁷ In the meantime, it may be noted that on the whole the translation, very likely the work of several individuals, is generally of good quality. The chief difficulties arise when the text is particularly difficult in terms of content or style; sometimes the translator is unable to create suitable lexical or phraseological means of expression, and sometimes he obviously has not understood the meaning and translates essentially morpheme for morpheme.⁴⁸ I shall confine myself here to a

⁴⁵ The photo-copies do not always reproduce the inner margins of C's folios. It is possible that this scholion is in the margin of 120r, though it seems a less appropriate spot. However, the relationship between the various illustrative passages is tenuous, and scribes obviously could have different opinions. Here we move quickly from Abraham back to Noah, then to Noah's descendants.

⁴⁶ Linguistically, it should be noted that the Chaldeans, Χαλδαῖοι, become *xladb* I73 138a4 (but in the originally non-marginal text, *xaldei*, 138a18), while Ἀρμένιοι become *ramene* 138a8 but *arōmeniu* in line 13. These two hypercorrections belong to the scribe of I73, and apply only to the formerly marginal list; R6 has *xaldb* and *xaldēi* (144r), *armene* and *armeniu*, 145v.

⁴⁷ William R. Veder, in his notes on the 1979 Salonika conference on Middle Greek and Slavonic literatures, reports that Capaldo is working with at least nine Greek manuscripts containing essentially the same material; *Polata knigopisnaja*, vol. 3 (Nijmegen, 1980), p. 59.

⁴⁸ An extreme example is where Gregory Nazianzen's verse listing of the books of the New Testament has an unexpected inversion, Δέκα δέ γε Παύλου καὶ τέσσαρες τ' ἐπιστολαί, where the "ten ... and four" means "14," as any good Christian should be

brief comment on a single passage which contains still another early Slavonic (probably Bulgarian) ghost-word.⁴⁹

Sreznevskij lists the peculiar noun *ščuritъ* ‘storax, sweet-smelling resin’, the sole example being Izb 243c27 *ognъ ... tŕčijъ maslo i ŝtŕoritъ*. A later scribe has added a gloss above the line, *fimijanъ*. But the translator understood the passage, *μόνον δὲ ἔλαιον δαπανᾷ* ‘consumes only oil’ and he used the OCS verb-form **išturitъ*, i.e., *iz-čuritъ*, presumably “turn into smoke,” cf. Sc, Mac., and Bg. verbs from **čuriti* “smoke (intrans.).” The scribe of I73 may not have understood, for this is a rare example of a third-person desinence *-tъ* in eleventh-century Russian; scribes regularly normalized to the local *-tъ* pronunciation (except in the Ostromir Gospel). Sreznevskij, like Nevostruev, was misled by the ancient gloss, but it is hard to see what meaning he found in the sentence.⁵⁰ In any case, we must erase Sreznevskij’s entry *ščuritъ* and make a new lemma *iščuriti*.

Although Nevostruev, Sreznevskij, and many others have skimmed I73 for interesting words, there is still a great deal to be discovered by scholars who actually read the text.⁵¹

able to figure out from the context if not the grammar. I73 has “10 Павлы кѣ чѣтырьмъ посланиjemъ по симъ.” The historical linguist rejoices to have the dative of “4” attested, but the student of translation wonders whether *каі* might somehow have been turned into *кѣ*. (A similar but more understandable blunder is found in the list of unfamiliar mountains in question 23C2 [see Table 1] where R6 has *tokasionъ*, corresponding to C120’s τὸ κ[αί] Σιών, a gloss—doubtless derived from psalm 122 (123):3—to the name of Mt. Hermon. V423 has τὸ καί Σινάιον, an obvious error, for Sinai is already in the list.

⁴⁹ Cf. H. G. Lunt, “Two East Slavic Ghost-Words: *ikonionъ* and *ikŕŕpinanъ*,” *Harvard Ukrainian Studies* 1 (1977): 23-28.

⁵⁰ The term *ὄλη* has been translated earlier in the sentence by the defensible but not really correct *debeloje*. Space does not allow me to discuss the complexity of the problem, for it involves intricate philosophical definitions.

⁵¹ Žukovskaja’s article about Nevostruev’s notes on the lexicon of I73, cited in fn. 5 above, is essentially a laudatory piece about this early scholar; in the context of a volume about I73 it is disappointing, because her only remark about later scholarship is that Sreznevskij took over all Nevostruev’s words with one exception. What is important, however, is that Sreznevskij added many items that Nevostruev did not include, and in other instances he tacitly corrected minor errors. Here I can comment only on one complex of words where Sreznevskij generally leads us to useful conclusions, and I will note one later contribution closer to our own time.

Žukovskaja remarks that Sreznevskij did not follow Nevostruev in listing *jubagъ*, but she is puzzled that he “obviously considered (it) a scribal error and therefore restored *jubag(r)ъ*” (IS 158). Sreznevskij, however, had actually read the text. He knew that the word referred to a sapphire and meant “πορφυρίζων, purplish.” He surely was aware that there are many careless misspellings in I73, and doubtless knew that at least one late copy of the text, Rumjancev 6, had the spelling *ubagrъ* here. Although he rightly associated it with *bagъrъ* ‘purple’, he incorrectly posited the initial letter as *ju*, although it surely should be Russian *u* for OCS **ŕ-*. This is shown by two other words from the same page

I73 is full of minor errors that, as the skimpy material from Djuvernua and others shows, can be corrected by reference to R6, KB, and perhaps other late copies. When the common earlier text has been established, much basic codicological, textual and linguistic work will still remain to be done. This is a series of tasks where cooperation between Slavists and Byzantinists would be particularly productive.⁵²

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Postscript. When writing this article, I missed the important note by Ivan V. L'ovočkin, "Izbornik Svjatoslava i ego slavjanskij protograf" (*Starobŭlgarska literatura*, bk. 8, 1980, pp. 46-49), who had already made the study of fol. 263v I have called for in fn. 6. The erased text surely reproduced the original wording calling *Simeon* "great among *emperors*"; the dedication to Svjatoslav was a last-minute affair. Accordingly, I must withdraw the fourth stage in the hypothetical series I posited in I73's genesis (p. 371), though the others remain. I am most grateful to Professor William R. Veder of Nijmegen for calling L'ovočkin's work to my attention.

(noted by Sreznevskij but not Nevostruev) and others from the same passage: **ozelenb* 'σμαραγδίζων, emerald-like' = *uzelenb* I 153b3 (referring to jasper), **očrmbn* 'όποπυρίζων, reddish' = *jočrmbn* I 153a24 (referring to the jacinth; this example not in Sreznevskij) and *učrmbn* I 122cъ (in Sreznevskij, referring to the transparent-red Sardian stone or carnelian and translating — probably inappropriately — πυρωπός 'of fiery-red appearance') as well as **osinb* 'όποκυανίζων, rather dark-blue' = *josinb* I 153d12 (referring to agate; in Sreznevskij). This series suffices to establish an ancient prefix **o-* with an attenuative sense, preserved in Slovene *očrn* 'blackish', *ostar* 'rather old'. It suggests also a formation with suffixal -b, so I hesitate whether to posit **obagər* or **obagər*. One hopes that other texts will furnish parallels which may resolve the question.

Žukovskaja reproduces without comment Nevostruev's *sasyz* (*sasyza*?), deduced from the locative *vъ sasyžь*. But this is immediately suspect, and one thinks rather of *sasyg* or *sasyga* — and indeed Sreznevskij shows unambiguously by citations from other old texts that these were real forms. Moreover, a thorough study by Omeljan Pritsak illustrates the varied forms of Slavic to have their bases in Turkic shapes of words with both the desired meanings, namely, "smelter" and "(earthenware) pot": "Bölgärische Etymologien I-III," *Ural-Altaische Jahrbücher* 19 (1957): 200-208.

⁵² This article was written early in 1982. *Novye knigi SSSR* announced in October that a costly facsimile edition of the *Izbornik* was scheduled to appear in the third quarter of 1983.